

Medical card · employer tracker guide

For Maria Santos · Acme Trucking LLC · operating duties under §391.41-§391.45

A driver with an expired medical card is an instant federal violation for both the driver and you. Tracking the expiration date is on you · the driver doesn't always remember, doesn't always update the state, and roadside inspectors don't care whose fault it is.

I · THE FOUR EMPLOYER OBLIGATIONS

1. **Verify the examiner** on the National Registry (NRCME) and document the verification date · [§391.23\(m\)](#)
2. **Obtain a copy of the medical certificate** · in the driver's DQ file within a reasonable time after the exam · [§391.43\(g\)](#)
3. **Track expiration** and remove the driver from CMV operation the day it expires · [§391.45](#)
4. **Confirm state CDLIS upload** · the certificate must be on file with the state CDL agency · if it's not, the CDL status goes to "not certified" and the driver is OOS regardless of the paper card

II · THE TRACKING CADENCE X3 COMPASS USES

DAYS BEFORE EXPIRATION	WHAT X3 COMPASS DOES	WHO GETS NOTIFIED
60 days	First reminder · book the exam	Driver + safety director
30 days	Escalation reminder · exam must be on calendar	Driver + safety director + dispatcher
7 days	Urgent reminder · OOS imminent	Driver + safety director + dispatcher · daily until resolved
Day of expiration	Driver placed on hold in tracker · audit-log entry	Safety director · escalate to operations
After exam	Card uploaded · CDLIS verification check · examiner re-verified on NRCME	Driver + safety director · cleared to drive

III · SHORT-CERT DRIVERS · WHY THEY NEED CLOSER ATTENTION

- **1-year card** · controlled hypertension, diabetes on oral meds, sleep apnea on CPAP · monitor compliance proof annually
- **3-month card** · uncontrolled hypertension under treatment, recent cardiac event, diabetes work-up · driver is on probationary medical clearance · ride along with operations + insurance to make sure ongoing exposure is acceptable
- **Insulin-treated diabetes** · separate ITDM exemption required · §391.46 · annual reverification of A1c + treating-provider letter
- **Vision / hearing exemption** · separate FMCSA exemption letter required · keep with the DQ file

IV · THE MOST COMMON DOT AUDIT FINDINGS

1. **Card expired · driver still on the road** · OOS for driver + violation for carrier
2. **No NRCME verification** · the examiner is on the registry but you didn't document checking · §391.23(m) violation
3. **State CDLIS shows "not certified"** · driver had a current paper card but never submitted it to the state · OOS for driver regardless
4. **Short-cert driver not on recert calendar** · 1-year card became 18-month gap before the next exam
5. **Insulin-treated driver without ITDM exemption** on file · disqualifying

The fix is automation, not vigilance. No safety director can mentally track 50 drivers' medical card expirations. X3 Compass's medical-card tracker is one of the highest-leverage features for any fleet · it eliminates the single most common OOS violation.